

State of Maine – Revised Y1 Budget Narrative

A. (Personnel) Salaries and Wages

	Year 1
Salary Total	\$2,045,825 \$933,361
Grant	\$2,045,825 \$933,361
Recipient Share*	\$ -0-

*Cost sharing only.

Title	Name	RHTP Initiative	Salary	Time	Mths	Yr 1 mt
# of Positions						27 20
Total:						\$2,045,825 \$933,361

Justification:

Title	Name	Project Responsibilities
RHTP Director	Dr. Lisa Letourneau Kristen McAuley	The RHTP Director will oversee the strategy, operations, and execution of the Rural Health Transformation Program. They will manage the RHTP Deputy Director, RHTP Fiscal & Compliance, and RHTP Data & Evaluation positions and report to the Department of Health and Human Services Commissioner.
RHTP Deputy Director	TBD	Provides support to Director and staff on development and implementation of various strategies to improve rural health care in Maine. Manages the five initiative leads (PM) positions; reports to RHTP Director.
RHTP Fiscal & Compliance	TBD Tyler Backus	Provides support to Director and oversees finances, administration, compliance, and reporting functions of this grant to ensure adherence to grant requirements. Oversees Administrative Support Vendor; reports to RHTP Director.
RHTP Data and Evaluation	TBD Deborah Bryant	Provides support to Director and oversees evaluation, data, and other coordination to ensure intended results are achieved. Oversees Evaluation Vendor; reports to RHTP Director.
Sustainable Ecosystem PM	TBD Ann Mukherjee	Manages day-to-day delivery of component project programming for Sustainable Ecosystems Initiative. Oversees external vendors and/or subrecipients executing program activities, monitor performance metrics, track progress against workplans, and identify operational risks or bottlenecks; reports to RHTP Deputy Director.
Population Health PM	TBD Eve Allen	Manages day-to-day delivery of component project programming for Population Health Initiative. Oversees external vendors and/or subrecipients executing program activities, monitor performance metrics, track progress against workplans, and identify operational risks or bottlenecks; reports to RHTP Deputy Director.

March 25, 2026

Technology & Innovation PM	Annie Arnzen TBD	Manages day-to-day delivery of component project programming for Technology & Innovation Initiative. Oversees external vendors and/or subrecipients executing program activities, monitor performance metrics, tracks progress against workplans, and identifies operational risks or bottlenecks; reports to RHTP Deputy Director.
Access PM	TBD	Manages day-to-day delivery of component project programming for Access Initiative. Oversees external vendors and subrecipients executing program activities. Monitors performance metrics, tracks progress against workplans, identifies operational risks or bottlenecks; reports to RHTP Deputy Dir.
Workforce PM	TBD	Manages day-to-day delivery of component project programming for Workforce Initiative. Oversees external vendors and subrecipients executing program activities. Monitors performance metrics, tracks progress against workplans, identifies operational risks or bottlenecks; reports to RHTP Deputy Dir.
DCM Contract Manager (2)	TBD	Manages day-to-day delivery of contract management to support RHTP program. Will work with RHTP Initiative Leads and leadership to ensure adherence to procurement rules; acquire services in efficient and effective manner; report to Director of Contract Management within ME Department of Health and Human Services.
DCM RFP Manager	TBD	Manages day-to-day delivery of contract management to support RHTP program. Will work with RHTP Initiative Leads and Leadership to ensure adherence to procurement rules; acquire services in efficient and effective manner; will report to Director of Contract Management within ME Department of Health and Human Services.
DHHS SC Senior Staff Accountant	Karen Erickson TBD	Apply advanced accounting skills to ensure proper functioning and accountability of fiscal operations; consult with agency program managers and internal/external accounting staff to identify business needs, compliance, and reporting requirements; reports to ME Director of the Department of Health and Human Services' Service Center.
DOL Director	Angelina Klouthis Jean	This position is part of Healthcare Training for ME PARTNERSHIP & directs overall operation of healthcare navigators and training teams; responsible for overseeing implementation of project activities, coordination with employers, other agencies and educational partners to identify and meet unmet training needs; providing strategic directions to apprenticeship team to create seamless healthcare pathways to retain and upskill staff. Year 1 costs are paid with Maine Jobs and Recovery Funding.
DOL Healthcare Program Manager	TBD	This position is part of Healthcare Training for ME PARTNERSHIP & directly oversees navigators to ensure jobseekers are connected to healthcare jobs and training; responsible for data collection, analysis and reporting on healthcare initiatives; work directly with training providers to fill industry training needs; manage contracts with training providers for new and incumbent healthcare workers including apprenticeship and pre-apprenticeship program development. Year 1 costs are paid with Maine Jobs and Recovery Funding.
DOL Career Center Consultant (3)	Jonathan Lounsberry TBD (2)	Positions are part of Healthcare Training for ME PARTNERSHIP & conducts outreach to employers and jobseekers, connecting jobseekers with healthcare training and career opportunities, and employers with recruitment and retention resources including support with apprenticeship program development. Position provides range of services including individualized support for jobseekers, re-employment, career counseling, connection to training, wraparound supports, and apprenticeship connections. Year 1 costs are paid with Maine Jobs & Recovery Funding.
HOPE Senior Planner	TBD	Position, as part of Workforce Initiative, will process participants' support service requests to eliminate barriers faced by healthcare students; report to Higher Opportunity for Pathways to Employment (HOPE) Program Manager within Office for Family Independence (OFI).
HOPE Eligibility Specialist II	TBD	Position is part of Workforce Initiative determines eligibility for participants' support service requests to eliminate barriers faced by healthcare students; reports to HOPE Program Manager within Office for Family Independence.

Sr Reimbursement Analyst	TBD	Position is part of Sustainable Ecosystems Initiative, will ensure efficient, sustainable, high value reimbursement of care; reports to Sustainable RH Ecosystems Initiative Lead.
Alternative Payment Model Coordinator	TBD	Position is part of Sustainable Ecosystems Initiative, will oversee and coordinate the development of alternative payment models; will report to Sustainable RH Ecosystems Initiative Lead.
Duals Coordinator	TBD	Position is part of Sustainable Ecosystems Initiative, will coordinate efforts to align and improve value of care related to members dually enrolled in Medicare and Medicaid. This position will report to the Sustainable RH Ecosystems Initiative Lead.
Comprehensive Health Planner II (3)	TBD	Positions are part of Population Health, will provide coordination and agreement oversight to 37 Community Healthcare Workers (CHWs) across 8 public health districts, 5 Tribal Health Clinics, and 15 School Based Health Centers.
Eligibility Specialists (18)	TBD	Positions are part of Access Initiative, will determine participant's eligibility for limited essential benefit plan for the uninsured. Positions will report to Family Independence Unit Supervisors within Office for Family Independence.
Comprehensive Health Planner II (32)	TBD	Positions are part of Access Initiative, will provide coordination between Maine Department of Transportation (DOT), Office of MaineCare Services (OMS), and Non-Emergency Transportation brokers to expand access to ride sharing opportunities; will report to Associate Directors of Operations within OMS and DOT.
IT Project Coordinator	TBD	This position, as part of Access Initiative, will provide project management to implement a new uninsured coverage group. This position will report to Medicaid Management Information System manager within Office of MaineCare Services.
Project Coordinator	TBD	Position is part of Access Initiative, provides project management to implement new coverage comparison tool; reports to Deputy Dir within Office of Health Insurance Marketplace.
Special Projects Manager (SNAP)	Patricia Dushuttle	Position, as part of Population Health, will provide coordination and agreement oversight to University of New England, nutrition education provider.

B. Fringe Benefits

	Year 1
Fringe Benefits Total	\$624,131 \$1,368,027
Grant	\$624,131 \$1,368,027
Recipient Share*	\$ -0-

*Cost sharing only.

		Year 1	
Fringe Benefit	Rate	Salary	Amt Requested

FICA	1.45%	933,361 2,045,825	13,534 \$29,664
Workers' Comp	\$1,674 annual/FTE	20 FTE 25 FTE	33,480 45,198
Normal Retirement	4.81%	549,491 1,676,480	26,431 80,639
Unfunded Retirement	16.05%	933,361 2,045,825	149,804 190,262
Retiree Health	9.30%	933,361 2,045,825	86,803 190,262
Pick-Up Retirement	4.80%	933,361 2,045,825	44,801 98,200
Health Insurance	Salary <\$50K \$26,626 Salary >\$50K<\$100K \$25,898 Salary>\$100K \$25,169	20 FTE 27 FTE	253,913 574,557
Dental Insurance	\$744/ FTE	20 FTE 27 FTE	14,880 20,088
Life Insurance	\$.52/ 000s of salary	933 2,046	485 1,064
Total:			624,131 1,368,027

C. Travel

	Year 1
Travel Total	\$7,844
Grant	\$7,844
Recipient Share*	\$ -0-

*Cost sharing only

			Year 1
Purpose of Travel	Item	Rate	Cost
Site Visits	Mileage	\$0.56 x 2400 miles	1,344
Annual Conference	Airfare	\$400/ flight x 5 persons	2,000
Annual Conference	Per Diem	\$184 x 5 persons	920
Annual Conference	Lodging	\$600 x 5 persons	3,000
Annual Conference	Mileage	\$0.56 x 200 miles	280

Annual Conference	Taxi	\$60 x 5 persons	300
Total:			7,844

Justification

The RHTP Director, Deputy Director, & three Initiative Leads will travel from Portland, ME to Baltimore, MD to attend CMS annual RHTP conference. Attending this conference is directly linked to project goals/objectives and is a necessity to learn from other States. The information and tools we will gather from attending this conference will help us to carry out project objectives by applying best practices. The Technology & Innovation Lead will also make periodic visits to rural communities and providers to assess their needs and experience in using RHTP supported technology and innovation initiatives. Visiting rural sites is directly linked to project goals and objectives and is necessary to directly assess progress, as well as potential barriers to implementation of RHTP activities. The information and feedback gathered will help us carry out RHTP activities more effectively and ensure cross-initiative success.

D. Equipment

	Year 1
Equipment Total	\$1,500,000
Grant	\$1,500,000
Recipient Share*	\$ -0-

*Cost sharing only

		Year 1
Item(s)	Rate	Cost
OB Adult and Infant Simulators	4 @ \$125,000	500,000
Adult Simulators- EMS	4 @ \$125,000	500,000
5-year-old Child Simulators- EMS	4 @ \$125,000	500,000
Total:		1,500,000

Justification

As part of the Workforce Initiative, Maine will expand upon their current mobile simulation lab capacity by adding four OB Adult & Infant Simulators, four Adult Simulators, and four 5-year-old Child Simulators. This new equipment will allow the delivery of realistic and safe training for healthcare students and professionals throughout the State, increasing accessibility to hands-on practice of critical skills in a controlled environment, especially for those living in rural areas. Estimated cost of simulators (\$125,000 each) is

based on a quote received in March 2025 of \$112,990 plus \$2,125 for installation plus \$9,885 per simulator for anticipated /projected cost increases from time of original estimate.

E. Supplies

	Year 1
Supply Total	139,120 119,152
Grant	139,120 119,152
Recipient Share*	\$ -0-

*Cost sharing only

		Year 1
Item(s)	Rate	Cost
Laptop Computer*	\$3,548/Year/FTE	70,960 60,316
General office supplies	\$600/Year/FTE	12,000 10,200
Employee Training	\$2508/Year/FTE	50,160 42,636
CoverME.gov User Guides	6,000 copies @ \$1 each/Year	6,000
Total:		139,120 119,152

Justification

General office supplies will be used by staff members to carry out daily activities of the program. Employee training is a standard annual budget line for staff members. The price of the laptop computer is consistent with those acquired from the Maine Office of Information Technology (MaineIT) for other employees of the organization and is based upon rates established by MaineIT for SFY26. The pricing of the selected computer is necessary because it includes the following tools: Standard Laptop, Software Subscription, Network Access & Support. The CoverME.gov User Guides will be purchased from a vendor selected through the competitive bidding process. These guides will be used to promote the Plan Comparison Tool and the use of CoverME.gov's consumer technology for enrollment decisions, contributing to the goals of Access Initiative.

*Annual Rate of \$3,548/Year/FTE is MaineIT's standard rate and includes Laptop, all Software Licenses, Network Access, Telephone, and Security

F. Consultant/Subrecipient/Contractual Costs

	Year 1
Contract/Subaward Total	184,914,773 111,961,833
Grant	184,914,773 111,961,833
Recipient Share*	\$ -0-

*Cost sharing only

					Year 1				
Organization Name or Service	Contract/Sub award	RHTP Initiative	Procurement	Start/ End	Cost				
Administrative Support Agreement	Contract	Central Oversight	Provider TBD via competitive procurement	4/1/26 - 9/30/30	1,200,000 1,000,000				
Scope: Maine will contract Administrative Support Vendor to provide operational and administrative capacity for RHTP Leadership Team. Vendor will support State's procurement and contracting process, drafting RFPs, RFQs, and subsequent agreements with outside entities, overseeing execution of scopes of work, reviewing budgets and invoices, monitoring expenditures, and supporting approvals and amendments. They will implement or use existing tools and dashboards to track progress, provide technical assistance to staff and subrecipients, and facilitate meetings with internal teams, grantees, and stakeholders.									
Accountability: RHTP Fiscal & Compliance lead will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
Evaluation Agreement(s)	MOU	Central Oversight	Provider TBD via competitive procurement	4/1/26 - 9/30/30	580,500 1,250,000				
Scope: Maine will contract with Evaluation Vendor to assess RHTP effectiveness. Vendor will establish reporting mechanisms, collect and structure data to track Maine RHTP metrics, design surveys, interviews, and other data collection tools, and will analyze quantitative and qualitative outcomes for translation into actionable recommendations. Vendor will develop dashboards and progress reporting tools internally and externally, supporting continuous improvement, informed decision-making, and stakeholder transparency. They will collaborate with the Administrative Support Vendor, Fiscal & Compliance Lead, and Data & Evaluation Lead to ensure data collection, reporting, and evaluation activities are aligned, accurate, and compliant with state and federal requirements.									
Accountability: RHTP Evaluation/Compliance/Data lead will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									

Staff Augmentation	Contract	Population Health	Sole sourced via State's Master Agreement	1/1/26- 9/30/30	368,749 1,034,278				
Scope: Provides funding for administrative staff to provide operational and administrative support to the Population Health initiative, including Community Paramedicine, and Peer Activity Coordinators; the Children's BH Clinical Consultant and Coordinator.									
Accountability: Population Health Initiative lead will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics for accountability.									
Administrative Consulting Services	Contract	Central Oversight	Statewide Staffing Contracts	4/1/26 - 9/30/30	490,488				
Scope: Provides funding for administrative staff to provide operational and administrative support for Central Oversight.									
Accountability: RHTP Director will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
Mobile Units Statewide Coordinator	Sub award	Population Health	Provider TBD via competitive procurement	4/1/26 - 9/30/30	500,000 625,000				
Scope: Develop a comprehensive inventory, implementation support toolkit, and assessment framework for mobile health units. Manage the RHTP funding to purchase and outfit new mobile units.									
Accountability: Population Health Initiative lead will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
Certified Community Behavioral Health Clinic (CCBHC)	Contract	Population Health	Provider TBD via competitive procurement	4/1/26- 9/30/30	200,000				
Scope: CCBHC cost reporting processes for provider. Support modeling of CCBHC costs to support state sustainability and decision-making.									
Accountability: Existing State staff will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
Aroostook Mental Health Services, Community Health & Counseling Services, Kennebec BH, Maine Behavioral Healthcare , Spurwink, Sweetser	Sub awards 5 6 Providers	Population Health	Sole Sourced based on Unique qualification	1/1/26 - 9/30/26	3,600,000 4,500,000				

Scope: Implement workflows, agreements, and physical space to embed primary care in each Certified Community Behavioral Health Clinic (CCBHC) service area.									
Accountability: Existing State staff will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics for accountability.									
School Based Health Centers (SBHCs)	Sub awards 15 Providers	Population Health	Providers TBD via competitive procurement	4/1/26 - 9/30/30	1,731,377 2,000,000				
Scope: Support current and new SBHCs with program management/oversight, tools and training to support billing, implementation, and infrastructure costs.									
Accountability: School-based Health Coordinator will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
University of New England (Consolidated Partner Agreement)	Sub award	Population Health	Training Vendor & Community Health Workers (CHWs)	4/1/26 - 9/30/30	12,058,319				
Scope: 1) Responsible for training and implementation funding for Evidence Based Practices (EBPs) that align with the goals of Maine's RHTP. 2) Funds for organizations that employ CHWs for incorporation of CHWs in innovative care delivery models in alignment with Maine's RHTP goals.									
Accountability: Population Health Initiative lead will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics with support from the Children's BH Clinical Consultant and Coordinator & for CHW Coordinator.									
Training Vendor	Sub award	Population Health	Provider TBD via competitive procurement	4/1/26 - 9/30/30	5,000,000	1,000,000	1,000,000	1,000,000	1,000,000
Scope: Responsible for training and implementation funding for Evidence Based Practices (EBPs) that align with the goals of Maine's RHTP.									
Accountability: Population Health Initiative lead will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics with support from the Children's BH Clinical Consultant and Coordinator.									
University of New England	Sub award	Population Health	Continuation of Existing Agreement	4/1/26 - 9/30/30	5,000,000				
Scope: Vendor to coordinate and administer directly, or subcontract with appropriate parties, nutrition education for rural communities and develop clinical linkages models with the Nutrition Education Coordinator.									
Accountability: Nutrition Education Coordinator will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
Community Paramedicine (CP) Implementation	Sub awards 10 Providers	Population Health	Provider TBD via competitive procurement	4/1/26 - 9/30/30	5,500,000				
Scope: Funds for EMS agencies licensed to provide Community Paramedicine Services in alignment with Maine's RHTP goals.									
Accountability: Community Paramedicine Coordinator will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									

Community Paramedicine (CP)/EMS Training Center	Sub award	Population Health	Provider TBD via competitive procurement	4/1/26 - 9/30/27	500,000				
Scope: Funds will help get Community Paramedicine educational training stood up in Maine.									
Accountability: Community Paramedicine Coordinator will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
Community Health Workers (CHWs)	Sub award	Population Health	Provider TBD via competitive procurement	4/1/26 - 9/30/30	4,000,000	1,000,000	1,000,000	1,000,000	1,000,000
Scope: Funds for organizations that employ CHWs for incorporation of CHWs in innovative care delivery models in alignment with Maine's RHTP goals.									
Accountability: CHW Coordinators will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
Healthy Acadia	Sub award	Population Health	Amendment to current agreement to expand services	1/1/26 - 9/30/30	929,965				
Scope: Funds the hiring and management of additional Peer Recovery Coaches to ensure all Maine EDs have a Recovery Coach.									
Accountability: Peer Activity Coordinator lead will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
Multiple Maine Behavioral health	Sub award	Population Health	Agreement amendment to expand services	1/1/26 - 9/30/30	1,070,035 2,000,000				
Scope: Funds the hiring and management of 23 additional Peer Recovery Coaches to ensure all Maine EDs have a Recovery Coach.									
Accountability: Peer Activity Coordinator lead will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
Sweetser	Sub award	Population Health	Agreement amendment to expand services	1/1/26 - 9/30/30	810,188 900,000				
Scope: Funds the hiring and management of 10 additional adult Certified Intentional Peer Support Specialists in additional Maine EDs.									
Accountability: Peer Activity Coordinator lead will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
Sweetser	Contract	Population Health	Agreement amendment to expand services	1/1/26 - 9/30/30	135,420 125,000				
Scope: Development of trainings for the integration of Peers in multi-disciplinary settings Deliver Core trainings 2x annually years 2-5, Deliver Continuing ed 2 x annually years 2-5, Train OBH staff and per-diem trainers to deliver all trainings for sustainability									
Accountability: Peer Activity Coordinator will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									

Medical Care Development (MCD)	Contract	Population Health	Sole Sourced based on Unique qualification	1/1/26 - 9/30/30	350,000				
Scope: Community Health Worker Training and Community Health Worker Supervisor Costs Defrayed									
Accountability: CHW Coordinators will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
Maine Community Health Worker CHW Initiative	Contract	Population Health	Provider TBD via competitive procurement	1/1/26 - 9/30/30	120,000				
Scope: Manage any RHT deliverables and scale CHW certification.									
Accountability: CHW Coordinators will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
Mercer Health Benefits	Contract	Population Health	Provider TBD via competitive procurement	1/1/26 - 9/30/30	275,000				
Scope: Assistance in meeting CCBHC Demonstration requirements for Cost Reporting and supporting analyses for CCBHC model sustainability.									
Accountability: CHW Coordinators will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
Wabanaki Public Health & Wellness	Sub award	Population Health	Sole Sourced based on Unique qualification	1/1/26- 9/30/30	1,836,821 956,961				
Scope: Ensure that tribal populations have access to critical substance use treatment and mental health support.									
Accountability: Population Health Initiative lead will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
Marketing and Attraction (media campaigns)	Contract	Workforce	Continuation of Existing Agreement	1/1/26 - 9/30/30	1,000,000				
Scope: Expand existing workforce attraction marketing campaign									
Accountability: Workforce Initiative lead will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
Finance Authority of Maine (FAME)	Sub award	Workforce	Sole Sourced based on Unique qualification	1/1/26 - 9/30/30	17,722,073 14,222,073				
Scope: Recruitment awards. May be used for relocation, or educational expenses									
Accountability: Workforce Initiative lead will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
MaineHealth	Sub award	Workforce	Continuation of Existing Agreement	1/1/26 - 9/30/30	5,000,000				

Scope: Consortium for Healthcare Education & Training (CHET) To expand rural clinical training sites and rotations, support preceptors									
Accountability: Workforce Initiative lead will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
MaineHealth	Sub award	Workforce	Sole Sourced based on Unique qualification	4/1/26 - 9/30/30	500,000				
Scope: Recalibrate training, and customized support to help rural providers practice at the top of their license, adapt to new technology									
Accountability: Contract will be managed by Workforce Initiative Lead; ultimately accountable to RHTP Program Deputy Director and Director									
Maine Department of Labor	MOU	Workforce	Sole Sourced based on Unique qualification	7/1/26 - 6/30/27	25,000				
Scope: Provide support to expand MaineJobLink which is a case management platform that will capture individual trainee, apprentice and pre-apprentice information of participants enrolled in Maine Department of Labor (MDOL) healthcare workforce programs to monitor enrollment, completion, employment and wage outcomes to include in overall grant reporting..									
Accountability: Workforce Initiative lead will oversee the MOU deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
Healthcare Training for ME PARTNERSHIP	MOU	Workforce	Sole Sourced based on Unique qualification	7/1/26 - 6/30/27	3,582,777				
Scope: Provide health career navigation and support to jobseekers. Administer tuition remission training funds for individuals and cohorts.									
Accountability: Workforce Initiative lead will oversee the MOU deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
Maine Department of Education	MOU	Workforce	Sole Sourced based on Unique qualification	7/1/26-6/30/27	940,000				
Scope: Development of career exploration programs and student pipeline through local school districts, and community-based organizations serving youth. Also provides funding for EMR upgrades/enhancements for distribution to school health nurses.									
Accountability: Workforce Initiative lead will oversee the MOU deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
Maine Health Data Organization	MOU	Workforce	Sole Sourced based on Unique qualification	1/1/26 - 9/30/30	250,000				
Scope: To design and deploy a centralized health workforce dashboard.									

Accountability: Workforce Initiative lead will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
Rural Medical Workforce Transportation Pilot	Sub award	Workforce	Maine Department of Transportation Provider TBD via competitive procurement	4/1/26 - 9/30/30	1,000,000 2,000,000				
Scope: Fund grants to providers to provide transportation to rural workers									
Accountability: Workforce Initiative lead will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
Medical Care Development (Consolidated Partner Agreement)	Sub award	Tech & Innovation	Sole Sourced based on Unique qualification	4/1/2026 - 9/30/2026	12,222,021				
Scope: Building on their experience as federal NETRC contractor to support telehealth implementation, MCD will serve as Subrecipient to provide overall project leadership, management, contracting, and oversight of contractors needed to implement all non-"state-owned" RHTP Tech & Innovation activities. Additionally, they will directly deliver services for several Tech & Innovation activities: Train Telehealth Facilitators & Implement Maine Rural AI Hub. Funding for staff and researchers focused on working with rural health AI startups and technology developers new AI health innovations aimed at addressing needs of rural health populations.									
Accountability: Technology & Innovation Initiative Lead will oversee contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
Medical Care Development (MCD) (federal NETRC contractor)	Sub award	Tech & Innovation	Sole Sourced based on Unique qualification	4/1/26 - 9/30/30	10,355,200				
Scope: Building on their experience as federal NETRC contractor to support telehealth implementation, MCD will serve as Subrecipient to provide overall project leadership, management, contracting, and oversight of contractors needed to implement all non-"state-owned" RHTP Tech & Innovation activities. Additionally, they will directly deliver services for several Tech & Innovation activities: Train Telehealth Facilitators & Implement Maine Rural AI Hub. Accountability: Technology & Innovation Initiative Lead will oversee contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
Medical Care Development (Consolidated	Sub award	Tech & Innovation	Provider TBD via competitive procurement	4/1/26 - 9/30/30	33,821,698 30,344,199				

Partner Agreement)									
Scope: Provider will distribute funds for providers & community organizations to create Telehealth Hubs and support EMR upgrades/enhancements, including cybersecurity enhancements & AI ambient documentation modules, or EMR replacements. Note: Max 5% cap on total annual budget (max \$10M/Yr) will be used for replacement of EMR system(s) that are HITECH certified as of Sept 1, 2025									
Accountability: Technology & Innovation Initiative Lead will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
Maine Connectivity Authority	Sub award	Tech & Innovation	Sole Sourced based on Unique qualification	4/1/26 - 9/30/30	200,000				
Scope: The purchase of telehealth hubs to improve connectivity and communication.									
Accountability: Technology & Innovation Initiative Lead will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
Tribal Health Center EMR upgrades Wabanaki Public Health & Welfare	Sub award	Tech & Innovation	Sole Sourced based on Unique qualification	1/1/26 - 9/30/30	790,000				
Scope: Information Technology equipment upgrades; broadband/network expansions; Information Technology consulting; EMR licensing; Integration & Training									
Accountability: Technology & Innovation Initiative Lead will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
Health Infonet (HIN) – Maine’s Health Information Exchange (HIE)	Sub award	Tech & Innovation	Sole Sourced based on Unique qualification	1/1/26 - 9/30/30	3,500,000				
Scope: Expand state designated, state-wide health information exchange (HIE) services									
Accountability: Technology & Innovation Initiative Lead will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
United Way of Southern Maine (CIE)	Sub award	Tech & Innovation	Sole Sourced based on Unique qualification	1/1/26 - 9/30/30	500,000				
Scope: Expand community information exchange (CIE) services									
Accountability: Technology & Innovation Initiative Lead will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
Rural AI Innovation Institute	Sub award	Tech & Innovation	Provider TBD via competitive procurement	4/1/26 – 9/30/30	500,250				

Scope: Funding for staff and researchers focused on working with rural health AI startups and technology developers new AI health innovations aimed at addressing needs of rural health populations.									
Accountability: Technology & Innovation Initiative Lead will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
Maine Health Data Organization	MOU	Sustainable Ecosystems	Sole Sourced based on Unique qualification	1/1/26 - 9/30/30	223,300				
Scope: Expand data reporting on uncompensated care provided by Federally Qualified Health Centers and Certified Community Behavioral Health Clinics									
Accountability: Access Initiative Lead will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
StationMD	Contract	Tech & Innovation	Expansion of Existing Agreement	4/1/2026 - 3/31/2027	499,440				
Scope: Telehealth services to provide Mainers with Intellectual and Developmental Disabilities who reside in group homes in rural areas to ensure 24/7 immediate care.									
Accountability: Technology & Innovation Initiative Lead will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
University of Maine System / ME Lifelong Communities	Sub award	Access	Sole Sourced based on Unique qualification	1/1/26 - 9/30/30	440,750				
Scope: Funds to partner with community-based organizations to strengthen and grow transportation programs. Funds would support needs such as standardized statewide training, stipends for transportation coordinators, trip scheduling software, volunteer promotion and recruitment activities, etc.									
Accountability: Access Initiative Lead will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
Market Research Focus Groups	Contract	Access	Provider TBD via competitive procurement	4/1/26 - 9/30/30	50,000				
Scope: This funding will be used to support user experience testing of the plan comparison tool, as well as testing of updates and user guide tools. The funds will cover participant surveying and recruitment, focus group facilitation, stipends for participants and materials creation. The funds will also cover offsite stakeholder meetings room rental and materials.									
Accountability: Access Initiative lead will oversee this contract, in conjunction with Office of the Health Insurance Marketplace (OHIM), using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
Department of Transportation	MOU	Access	MOU with state agency	10/1/26- 9/30/28	500,000				
Scope: Develop Implementation plan focused on a mobility management approach									
Accountability: Access Initiative lead will oversee this MOU using deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									

TBD (Consolidated Partner Agreement)	Sub award	Sustainable Ecosystems	Hospital Efficiency Oversight, planning & Financial Management Funds	4/1/26- 9/30/30	35,350,000				
Scope: Manage Hospital Financial Improvement, and Rural Regional Planning Activities, and Support Provider APM Transitions: includes development of hospital-specific financial management plans; provision of financial management technical assistance; distribution and oversight of hospital stabilization funding; planning, coordination and facilitation of regional rural health planning process; distribution and management of regional rural health planning funds; and provide support and providing technical assistance (TA) to non-hospital providers, with a focus on providing education, TA, and networking opportunities that support APM participation and transitions for these providers. Hospital Efficiency & Financial Improvement Funds: Provides Hospital payments to support senior hospital staff to participate in tailored financial sustainability planning, technical assistance, and transformation activities; and for capital and non-EMR technology needs for vulnerable hospitals. Develop Alternative Payment Model (APM) for MaineCare PCPlus program, building off earlier work and phases.									
Accountability: Sustainable Ecosystems Initiative lead will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
Hospital Financial Improvement, Rural Regional Planning & Provider APM Transition (Oversight)	Sub award	Sustainable Ecosystems	Provider TBD via competitive procurement	4/1/26-9/30/30	1,888,312				
Scope: Manage Hospital Financial Improvement, and Rural Regional Planning Activities, and Support Provider APM Transitions: includes development of hospital-specific financial management plans; provision of financial management technical assistance; distribution and oversight of hospital stabilization funding; planning, coordination and facilitation of regional rural health planning process; distribution and management of regional rural health planning funds; and provide support and providing technical assistance (TA) to non-hospital providers, with a focus on providing education, TA, and networking opportunities that support APM participation and transitions for these providers.									
Accountability: Sustainable Ecosystems Initiative lead will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									

Hospital Efficiency & Financial Management Funds (Capital)	Sub-award	Sustainable Ecosystems	Provider TBD via competitive procurement	1/1/26-9/30/28	29,000,000				
Scope: Hospital Efficiency & Financial Improvement Funds: Provides Hospital payments to support senior hospital staff to participate in tailored financial sustainability planning, technical assistance, and transformation activities; and for capital and non-EMR technology needs for vulnerable hospitals.									
Accountability: Sustainable Ecosystems Initiative lead will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
Maine Health Data Organization	MOU	Sustainable Ecosystems	Sole Sourced based on Unique qualification	1/1/26 - 9/30/30	831,250 750,750				
Scope: Produce public dashboard related to hospital financial health and uncompensated care; develop robust provider database for regional health planning.									
Accountability: Sustainable Ecosystems Initiative lead will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
Contracted Staff Support in the Office of Affordable Health Care	Contract	Sustainable Ecosystems	Sole sourced via State's Master Agreement	4/1/26-9/30/30	261,688				
Scope: Contracted support staff to provide administrative assistance to meet RHTP goals and objectives.									
Accountability: Sustainable Ecosystems Initiative lead will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics									
Manatt Health	Contract	Sustainable Ecosystems	Agreement amendment to expand services	1/1/26-9/30/27	285,000	1,000,000	1,000,000	1,000,000	1,000,000
Scope: Develop Alternative Payment Model (APM) for MaineCare PCPlus program, building off earlier work and phases.									
Accountability: Sustainable Ecosystems Initiative lead will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
Individual Providers	Sub awards	Sustainable Ecosystems	Subgrants to providers	10/1/26- 9/30/27	28,600,949				
Scope: To provide funding to providers to support their work in moving towards APM.									
Accountability: Sustainable Ecosystems Initiative lead will oversee these subgrants using deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
Milliman	Contract	Sustainable Ecosystems	Agreement amendment to expand services	1/1/26 - 9/30/27	167,000				

Scope: Develop adequate, economic and efficient reimbursement methodology for school-based health centers, that rewards high value care.									
Accountability: Sustainable Ecosystems Initiative lead will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
Dental Reimbursement Development	Contract	Sustainable Ecosystems	Provider TBD via competitive procurement	4/1/26 - 9/30/26	250,000				
Scope: Develop adequate, economic and efficient dental reimbursement to assist with dental access.									
Accountability: Sustainable Ecosystems Initiative lead will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
Gainwell	Contract	Sustainable Ecosystems	Agreement amendment to expand services	1/1/26 - 9/30/28	250,000				
Scope: Implement Change Requests to MaineCare claims system to implement rates and Alternative Payment Models.									
Accountability: Sustainable Ecosystems Initiative lead will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
Interagency Facility Transportation	Sub award	Sustainable Ecosystems	Provider TBD via competitive procurement	4/1/26 - 9/30/30	250,000 1,000,000				
Scope: Provides funding to supports the expansion of the MedComm system throughout all hospitals, with coordination and oversight.									
Accountability: Access Initiative Lead will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
MaineCare Non-Emergency Medical Transportation Brokers	Contract	Access	Agreement amendment to expand services	10/1/28 - 9/30/30					
Scope: Provides funding for implementation of coordinated cost sharing model/ technical solution with transportation providers to enable coordinated ride sharing to boost access to transportation for health related social needs.									
Accountability: Access Initiative Lead will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
Gainwell	Contract	Population Health	Agreement amendment to expand services	10/1/29 - 9/30/30					
Scope: To fund MaineCare enrollment and claims processing systems to cover Community Paramedicine Services									
Accountability: Population Health Initiative lead will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
Gainwell	Contract	Access	Agreement amendment to expand services	10/1/29 - 9/30/30					
Scope: Provides funding for the Provider Enrollment Application upgrade									

Accountability: Access Initiative Lead will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
Ride-Share App	Contract	Access	Provider TBD via competitive procurement	10/1/26-9/30/27					
Scope: Development of a Medicaid transportation cost share app to enable ride sharing for non-Medicaid health-related social needs in rural communities									
Accountability: Access Initiative Lead will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
Maine Health Data Organization	Contract	Access	Sole-Sourced based on Unique qualification	10/1/27-9/30/30					
Scope: Expand data reporting on uncompensated care provided by Federally Qualified Health Centers and Certified Community Behavioral Health Clinics									
Accountability: Access Initiative Lead will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
IdeaCrew	Contract	Access	Agreement amendment to expand services	10/1/27-9/30/30					
Scope: To provide funding for the Plan Comparison Tool for use on CoverME.gov.									
Accountability: Access Initiative lead will oversee this contract, in conjunction with Office of the Health Insurance Marketplace (OHIM), using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
Regional Planning Funds (Capital)	Contract	Sustainable Ecosystems	Provider TBD via competitive procurement	10/1/27-9/30/30					
Scope: Rural Regional Planning Funds: Provides funds for providers to align with regional Health Ecosystem planning goals for capital and non-EMR technology costs, workforce recruitment incentives, and for support to establish new legal and business structures.									
Accountability: Sustainable Ecosystems Initiative lead will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
Multi-Payer Alternative Payment Model	Contract	Sustainable Ecosystems	Provider TBD via competitive procurement	10/1/27-9/30/30					
Scope: Develop multi-payer Alternative Payment Model for rural hospital reimbursement									
Accountability: Sustainable Ecosystems Initiative lead will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
Durable Medical Equipment Development	Contract	Sustainable Ecosystems	Provider TBD via competitive procurement	10/1/26-9/30/27					
Scope: Develop adequate, economic and efficient reimbursement methodology, as well as research and development of procurement solutions, for Durable Medical Equipment to help ensure access in a difficult rural market.									
Accountability: Sustainable Ecosystems Initiative lead will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
MaineCare Rate Support	Contract	Sustainable Ecosystems	Provider TBD via competitive procurement	10/1/28-9/30/30					

Scope: Support as needed to develop additional identified adequate, economic and efficient reimbursement for MaineCare covered services.									
Accountability: Sustainable Ecosystems Initiative lead will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
Sweetser	Contract	Sustainable Ecosystems	Agreement amendment to expand services	4/1/26—9/30/26	3,400,000				
Scope: Support renovations of existing site. Accounted for under cost settlement process.									
Accountability: Sustainable Ecosystems Initiative lead will oversee this contract using contractual deliverable schedules and performance metrics.									
Total:					184,914,773 111,961,833				

G. Construction (not applicable)

H. Other

	Year 1
Other Total	1,200,000 71,148,448
Grant	1,200,000 71,148,448
Recipient Share*	\$ -0-

*Cost sharing only.

	Year 1	
Item(s)	Quantity	RHTP Initiative
New England Rural Health Association (NERHA)	1	Central Oversight
Telehealth Units (One Time Purchase)	200 x \$1000/unit	Technology & Innovation
MaineIT System Improvements	N/A	Technology & Innovation
MaineJobLink	1	Workforce
Healthcare Training for ME PARTNERSHIP	N/A	Workforce
Health Career Academy	N/A	Workforce

EMR upgrades/enhancements	200 x Avg \$152,246/provider	Technology & Innovation	30,449,199
Direct Provider Payments (Uncompensated Care)			
Provider APM Transition Payments	N/A	Access	-28,501,208
Direct Provider Payments (Essential Benefits for Uninsured)	N/A	Access	\$0
Mobility Management	N/A	Access	505,000
Total:			1,200,000 71,148,448

Justification

- We are requesting funds for the development of New England Rural Health Association (NERHA)'s proposed New England Rural Health Transformation Center, a cross-state collaborative that will provide technical assistance on RHTP issues faced across the states, including policy and regulatory issues, data sharing, and opportunities for shared services.
- ~~We plan on partnering with the Maine Department of Public Safety, Emergency Medical Services, and are requesting funds to provide telehealth units to the remaining ~200 EMS agencies to enable emergency communications with providers and increase telehealth capacity.~~
- We also plan on partnering with the Maine Center for Disease Control (MeCDC) and Office for Child and Family Services (OCFS) to implement or modernize in-house data systems to improve healthcare, e.g. CHARM; EMR upgrade & iPads for ME Public Health Nurses.
- ~~We are requesting funds to expand MaineJobLink, which is a case management platform that will capture individual trainee, apprentice and pre-apprentice information of participants enrolled in Maine Department of Labor (MDOL) healthcare workforce programs to monitor enrollment, completion, employment and wage outcomes to include in overall grant reporting.~~
- ~~We are requesting funds for the Healthcare Training for ME PARTNERSHIP, which is a partnership with DHHS Office for Family Independence, Higher Opportunities for People and Education (HOPE), Office of Aging & Disabilities, MDOL, Department of Education (DOE), Maine Community College System (MCCS), University of Maine System (UMS) and employers offering "earn while you learn" trainings.~~
- ~~Costs will vary by provider, but estimate 200 providers @ avg cost of \$152,246/provider for EMR updates, enhancements & replacements~~

~~New EMR tools (annual costs per provider):~~

AI Bundle	\$15,000
Population Health Bundle	\$12,000
Telehealth tools	\$2,400
No Show Predictor	\$2,400
Coding & billing tools	\$2,400
Data reporting upgrades	\$1,200
Authorization management tool	\$1,200

New peripherals	\$4,646
Total New EMR Tools	\$ 41,246

Assoc'd Staff Time to Implement New EMR tools (costs per provider):-

IT expert consultant/advisor	\$25,000 IT consultant @\$100,000/practice / 3 providers
IT staff	\$75,000 Practice IT staff for implementation
Project management time	\$5,000 Staff time @\$50/hr X 100hrs
Provider training time	\$6,000 Provider time @\$120/hr X 50hrs
Total Staff costs for implementation	\$111,000
TOTAL	\$152,246

- Finally, we are requesting funds for “Provider APM Transition Payments” to support providers that serve as critical access points for rural communities and participate in these efforts to prepare for adoption of APMs and/or evolution of APM participation. direct payments to hospitals for uncompensated care, in Year 1, and for the new uninsured coverage group, beginning in Year 2. These payments will mirror Medicaid reimbursement rates for limited essential coverage.

I. Total Direct Costs

	Year 1
Direct Total	189,299,261 188,171,097
Grant	189,299,261 188,171,097
Recipient Share*	\$ -0-

*Cost sharing only.

	Year 1
A. Personnel	933,361 2,045,825
B. Fringe Benefits	624,131 1,368,027
C. Travel	7,844

D. Equipment	1,500,000
E. Supplies	139,120 119,152
F. Contractual	111,961,833 184,914,773
G. Construction	-
H. Other	71,148,448 1,200,000
Total Direct Charges	188,171,097 189,299,261

J. Indirect Costs

	Year 1
Indirect Total	1,836,954 708,790
Grant	1,836,954 708,790
Recipient Share*	\$ -0-

*Cost sharing only.

		Year 1
Item(s)	Rate/Base	Cost
StaCap	3.126%	1,584,830 456,666
Di-Cap	Approved PACAP Plan	252,124
Total:		1,836,954 708,790

Justification

Sta-Cap is the State Cost Allocation Plan which is charged at a rate of 3.126% and is computed on the following direct cost base of \$14,608,637 in Year 1. Di-Cap is the Departments of Health and Human Services' allocation plan computed in accordance with the federally approved PACAP.